

Emilio Barkett

EDUCATION	Columbia University M.A. in Media Studies & Sociology Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu Thesis: <i>Status Hierarchies in Language Models</i> Brigham Young University–Hawaii B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science Research Advisor: Mason Allred	2024 – 2025 2022 – 2024
AREAS OF INTEREST	AI Safety; Language Model Behavior; Organizational Risk; Human-AI Interaction	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Supervised Program for Alignment Research <i>Research Mentor</i> Columbia AI Alignment Club <i>Research Manager / Fellowship Facilitator</i> Columbia Business School <i>Research Intern</i> Research Advisor: Alan Zhang Columbia University <i>Research Assistant</i> Research Advisor: James Chu	Berkeley, CA (<i>Remote</i>) Dec 2025 – Present New York, NY Jan 2025 – Dec 2025 New York, NY June 2025 – Aug 2025 New York, NY Jan 2025 – July 2025
BOOK	[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati. Emilio Barkett <i>Barnes and Noble Press</i> , 2022. [link]	
PUBLICATIONS	[9] Normalization of Deviance in AI Development.* Emilio Barkett, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol <i>NeurIPS 2026 AI4Good Workshop</i>. (under review). [arXiv]. [8] Social Pressure Induces Moral Sycophancy in Frontier LLMs.* Roshni Lulla, Kristin Witte, Saloni Modi, Emilio Barkett <i>Working Paper</i>. [7] Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts.* Niklas Weller, Emilio Barkett <i>ICML 2026 Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment</i>. [arXiv]. [6] Representation Without Control: Testing the Realization Effect in Language Models.* Ciaran Walsh, Emilio Barkett <i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). [arXiv]. [5] The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority. Emilio Barkett <i>Preprint</i>, 2026. [arXiv] [4] Status Hierarchies in Language Models. Emilio Barkett <i>Master’s Thesis</i>, 2026. [arXiv]. [3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs. Emilio Barkett, Olivia Long, Paul Kröger <i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). [arXiv]. [2] Don’t Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models. Paul Kröger, Emilio Barkett <i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). [arXiv].	

- [1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs.
Emilio Barkett, Olivia Long, Madhavendra Thakur
ICML 2025 Workshop on Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment. [arXiv].

* Denotes projects mentored through the Supervised Program for Alignment Research (SPAR).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- [2] Illusion of Explanatory Depth in LLMs.
 Hayzie Chu, Andrew Xie, Shruti Das, **Emilio Barkett**
Working Paper.
- [1] Legislative Boundary-Work and the Professional Response to Artificial Intelligence.
Emilio Barkett
Working Paper.

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Supervised Program for Alignment Research, \$5,250.	Dec 2025 – Present
Claude Campus Ambassador, Anthropic, \$1,750.	Aug 2025 – Dec 2025
AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club.	Jan 2025 – June 2025
Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500.	2022
Dean's List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500.	2022

PRESENTATIONS

Conferences

- ICML 2026 Workshop, Seoul, South Korea, July 2026. *Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts*
- Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- ICML 2025 Workshop, Vancouver, Canada, July 2025. *Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs*
- Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. *Surveillance on Campus*
- Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. *Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative*

MENTORING

Research Mentoring

- Alexander Kimpton (2026), Dragoman. Published. [9].
- Yusuf Kundgol (2026), Oxford. Published. [9].
- Daniel Graham (2026), State Street. Published. [9].
- Shruti Das (2026), Columbia University Masters. Former Apple.
- Weian Xie (2026), MIT.
- Saloni Modi (2026), Bloomberg. Former UT Austin. Published. [8].
- Hayzie Chu (2026), Brown University Undergrad.
- Niklas Weller (2026), University of St. Gallen PhD. Published. [7].
- Roshni Lulla (2026), USC PhD. Published. [8].
- Raghav Pant (2026), JPMorganChase. Former Brown University.
- Dan Sachs (2026), Independent Researcher. Former Georgetown University.
- Ciáran Walsh (2026), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [6].
- Madhavendra Thakur (2025), Independent Researcher. Published. [1]. Now at Harvard; YC Fellow.
- Olivia Long (2025), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [1, 3]. Former XLab.

ACADEMIC
SERVICE

Program Committee Member

- Workshops: AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026, 2027)

Reviewer

- Conferences: NeurIPS (2025, 2026), IASEAI (2026)
- Workshops: SocialAgent (NeurIPS 2026), Interpretability as a Science (NeurIPS 2026), AI4GOOD (NeurIPS 2026), AI and the Self (2026), Pluralistic Alignment (ICML 2026), Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modeling Research (COLM 2025)

TECHNICAL
SKILLS

Languages & Tools:

Python, R, HTML, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Figma, Qualtrics, Amazon MTurk, Prolific Academic, Open Science Framework, arXiv

Human Languages:

English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)